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Department of Computer Engineering

Academic Year: 2025-26

Experiment no 11:

D3.js Lab: Building an Animated Bar Chart from Scratch

1. Requirements

VS Code
Chrome Browser
Live Server Extension

2. Create Project Structure

Create a folder and files as follows:

d3-lab
index.html
style.css
script.js

5. Step 1 Basic HTML Setup

Create index.html

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <title>D3 Bar Chart</title>
  <script src="https://d3js.org/d3.v7.min.js"></script>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
</head>
<body>
  <h1>Bar Chart Race</h1>
  <div id="chart"></div>
  <script src="script.js"></script>
</body>
</html>
```

Run using Live Server. The page should display only the heading.

6. Step 2 Basic Styling

Create style.css

```
body {
  font-family: Arial;
  text-align: center;
}
#chart {
  margin-top: 30px;
}
```

7. Step 3 Add Dataset

Open script.js and add

```
const data = [
  {year: 2020, name: "A", value: 50},
```



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```
{year: 2020, name: "B", value: 30},  
{year: 2020, name: "C", value: 20},  
{year: 2021, name: "A", value: 60},  
{year: 2021, name: "B", value: 40},  
{year: 2021, name: "C", value: 25},  
{year: 2022, name: "A", value: 80},  
{year: 2022, name: "B", value: 50},  
{year: 2022, name: "C", value: 35}  
];
```

8. Step 4 Create SVG

```
const width = 600;  
const height = 400;  
const svg = d3.select("#chart")  
  .append("svg")  
  .attr("width", width)  
  .attr("height", height);
```

9. Step 5 Create Scales

```
const xScale = d3.scaleLinear()  
  .range([0, width - 100]);  
  
const yScale = d3.scaleBand()  
  .range([0, height])  
  .padding(0.2);
```

10. Step 6 Create Update Function

```
function update(year) {  
  const yearData = data.filter(d => d.year === year);  
  xScale.domain([0, d3.max(yearData, d => d.value)]);  
  yScale.domain(yearData.map(d => d.name));  
  const bars = svg.selectAll("rect")  
    .data(yearData, d => d.name);  
  bars.enter()  
    .append("rect")  
    .attr("y", d => yScale(d.name))  
    .attr("height", yScale.bandwidth())  
    .attr("x", 0)  
    .attr("width", 0)  
    .attr("fill", "steelblue")  
    .merge(bars)  
    .transition()
```



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```
.duration(1000)
.attr("y", d => yScale(d.name))
.attr("width", d => xScale(d.value));
```

```
bars.exit().remove();
}
```

11. Step 7 Call Function

```
update(2020);
```

Bars should now be visible.

12. Step 8 Add Animation

```
const years = [2020, 2021, 2022];
let i = 0;
setInterval(() => {
  update(years[i]);
  i = (i + 1) % years.length;
}, 1500);
```

Bars will animate automatically.

13. Step 9 Add Labels

Add this inside the update function after bars code

```
const labels = svg.selectAll("text")
  .data(yearData, d => d.name);

labels.enter()
  .append("text")
  .attr("y", d => yScale(d.name) + 20)
  .attr("x", 5)
  .text(d => d.name)
  .merge(labels)
  .transition()
  .attr("y", d => yScale(d.name) + 20);

labels.exit().remove();
```

14. Output

An animated bar chart should be visible with changing values across years.

15. Practice Tasks

- Change dataset values
- Change bar color by modifying fill attribute
- Change animation speed by reducing duration
- Add one more category to dataset